

George Douglas Papers annotated transcription

Volume I

Guide and finding aid with sermon and church papers

Version 1.1

September 2026

Prepared for Volney Douglas
For contribution to Abilene Christian University
Special Collections and Archives

Direct transcription with marked uncertainties and editorial notes. Original scans supplied by ACU; AI-assisted typescript offered for repository review.

This volume covers 15 source scan pages. The complete set covers six PDFs and 387 scan pages. Damaged passages remain partial or tentative where marked.

Volumes in this edition

- I Guide and finding aid with sermon and church papers
- II Folder 1 Correspondence and loan papers
- III Folder 2 Correspondence and legal papers
- IV Folder 3 Correspondence and legal papers

Editorial guide

Purpose and scope

This edition offers a direct, annotated transcription of the six supplied PDFs of the George Douglas Papers, 1830–1939, Center for Restoration Studies MS 5, Abilene Christian University Special Collections and Archives. It accounts for all 387 scan pages, including repository covers, later identifying slips, envelopes, duplicate images and fragments. Some damaged passages remain only partly transcribed. Folders 4–7 described in the finding aid were not supplied as manuscript scans and are outside this edition.

Preparation and review

Prepared for Volney Douglas with AI assistance in September 2026, from visual reading of the supplied scans. Each scan received an initial reading. Version 1.1 adds local OCR processing of all 193 pages containing the original 1,200 uncertainties, and applies selected image-checked corrections. OCR completion is not a complete new visual check; the item ledger records which passages were individually adjudicated. The page inventory identifies the review level. This edition has not received an independent human transcription check or repository approval. It is offered for scholarly review and correction, and does not replace the source images.

Independence

The first edition was prepared separately from the plain-English family edition. For version 1.1, the other agent's contextual review and the family edition were consulted to guide image checks; this revision is not a blinded comparison. Part of a pre-existing 25-page transcription was viewed during the initial inventory, before the request for independence; it has not been used for this transcription. The work is therefore not a blind experiment.

Wording and layout

Original wording, spelling, grammar, abbreviations and recoverable punctuation are retained. No silent expansion or modernization is intended. Handwritten capitalization, punctuation and word division sometimes require judgment. Superscripts are lowered to the baseline. Ordinary line wrapping is reflowed; verse lines, addresses and separate text blocks are distinguished. Underlining and decorative features are not systematically encoded. This is a direct reading transcript, not a facsimile or a fully diplomatic edition.

Uncertainty notation

Double square brackets contain editorial intervention. `[[illegible]]` means writing could not be read; an unspecified gap does not imply a word count. Adjacent unreadable spans may be combined. A stated extent, such as `[[illegible: approximately 3 words]]`, is an estimate. `[[word?]]` gives a tentative reading, including tentative phrases. `[[lost: torn edge]]` records writing missing at a damaged edge; `[[obscured: fold]]` identifies an obstruction. Original single brackets remain as written. No missing wording is supplied solely to produce a fluent sentence.

Corrections and separate blocks

[[deleted: text]] records readable canceled text; [[deleted: illegible]] records an unread cancellation. [[inserted: text]] records a significant insertion in its intended position. [[margin]] and [[/margin]] enclose marginal writing. [[postmark]] and [[postage]] identify postal text. [[blank]], [[seal]] and [[sketch]] identify useful non-textual features. A [[separate block: description]] marker introduces an independently positioned passage. Handwriting or cancellation may itself be uncertain.

Source order and later descriptions

Entries follow the PDFs' scan order. Where the leaves appear out of sequence, the editorial note suggests a reading order without moving the entry. Later identifying slips are transcribed separately; their names, dates and attributions are not silently substituted for manuscript readings. Duplicate scans retain separate entries. Apparent contradictions are recorded rather than reconciled.

Documentary statements

The letters preserve their writers' assertions, beliefs, rumors and opinions. Transcription does not establish those statements as historical fact. Historical racial language and other offensive wording remain where legible. The original scans are the evidence against which this typescript should be checked.

References and corrections

A page ID such as 05-025 means source 05, PDF scan page 25, counting the cover as page 1. A block ID such as 05-025-P02 adds the second transcript paragraph or block. These are editorial locators; they are not manuscript page numbers. Suggested citation: George Douglas Papers annotated transcription, version 1.1, 05-025-P02; corresponding source 05, scan page 25. For a correction, give that locator, the existing wording, a proposed reading, and the image or other evidence supporting it.

Files for reuse

The package includes four searchable PDFs and four editable Word files, a complete UTF-8 transcript, structured JSON, an offline HTML reading copy, a page inventory, and an unresolved-readings register in TSV and HTML. The register retains the original uncertainty IDs; resolved IDs are retired and new IDs use higher numbers. The review ledger preserves all 1,200 baseline items. The register includes tentative readings, unread text, loss and obstruction; structural markers and readable insertions or deletions are not unresolved items. Original source PDFs are identified by filename and SHA-256 checksum but are not duplicated in this package.

Repository credit

Original documents and scans: George Douglas Papers, 1830–1939, Center for Restoration Studies MS 5, Abilene Christian University Special Collections and Archives, Brown Library, Abilene Christian University, Abilene, Texas. Collection address printed in the supplied files: https://digitalcommons.acu.edu/george_douglas. This contribution acknowledges the repository's work in preserving and scanning the collection. No repository endorsement or transfer of copyright is asserted.

Transcription guidance

The general approach of retaining original spelling and abbreviations and marking uncertainty is informed by the Smithsonian Transcription Center's How to Transcribe guidance, consulted September 2026: <https://transcription.si.edu/instructions/transcribe>. This edition defines its own notation and is not a Smithsonian project.

Source inventory

Source 01

ACU CRS MS5 - 01 - Finding Aid, George Douglas Papers 1830-1939.pdf

PDF scan pages: 6

SHA-256: 407ac150385b7e1c4a35111fbd2dc113c52d59534b9219200b153c81d19bd22c

Source 02

ACU CRS MS5 - 02 - L. Douglas Sermon Notes, 16 Feb 1883.pdf

PDF scan pages: 4

SHA-256: d0f97a4967414638c7ebf74064633a5571f39f6cb6d753971b79bed17d75daed

Source 03

ACU CRS MS5 - 03 - Sylvana Church Endorsement for George Douglas, Sept 1888.pdf

PDF scan pages: 5

SHA-256: ffd6cdfaac980365018773c286940767b5bce0c3c1ab285c3c7ad1b434263d57

Source 04

ACU CRS MS5 - 04 - Folder 1, Correspondence and Loan Papers.pdf

PDF scan pages: 96

SHA-256: 5c93172385acbe177e2cfb2f190f58fbd534ee5a468be3843ad6dc6ae91ed2bb

Source 05

ACU CRS MS5 - 05 - Folder 2, Correspondence and Legal Papers.pdf

PDF scan pages: 158

SHA-256: 84e92f46ff5208da786ecda5bb9b497766d054a596b8383e760626a975286cbf

Source 06

ACU CRS MS5 - 06 - Folder 3, Correspondence and Legal Papers.pdf

PDF scan pages: 118

SHA-256: d9ef810f7432dac5f9d1949cea8708f92bb447e8a431a550ea11c22c3a1cce76

Source 01

ACU CRS MS5 - 01 - Finding Aid, George Douglas Papers 1830-1939.pdf

6 PDF scan pages including the repository cover.

SHA-256: 407ac150385b7e1c4a35111fbd2dc113c52d59534b9219200b153c81d19bd22c

Scan 001 01-001

Repository cover | Source 01, PDF page 1

01-001-P01 Abilene Christian University
Digital Commons @ ACU

01-001-P02 George Douglas Papers
Digitized Manuscripts, Personal Papers and Archival Records

01-001-P03 1-16-2019

01-001-P04 Finding Aid for George Douglas Papers, (1830-1939)

01-001-P05 Abilene Christian University Special Collections and Archives

01-001-P06 Follow this and additional works at: https://digitalcommons.acu.edu/george_douglas
Part of the Christianity Commons, Genealogy Commons, Military History Commons, Social History Commons, and the United States History Commons

01-001-P07 Recommended Citation
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Scan 002 01-002

Printed finding aid | Source 01, PDF page 2

01-002-P01 George Douglas
Papers, (1830-1939)

01-002-P02 Center for Restoration Studies
Manuscripts #5

01-002-P03 Abilene Christian University Special Collections and Archives
Brown Library
Abilene Christian University
Abilene, TX 79699-9208

01-002-P04 16 January 2019

Scan 003 01-003

Printed finding aid | Source 01, PDF page 3

01-003-P01 About this collection

Title: George Douglas Papers

01-003-P02 Creator: George Douglas

01-003-P03 Identifier/Call Number: Center for Restoration Studies Manuscripts #5

01-003-P04 Physical Description: 1 linear feet (2 boxes)

01-003-P05 Dates (Inclusive): 1830-1939

01-003-P06 Dates (Bulk): 1830-1939

01-003-P07 Location: Center for Restoration Studies

01-003-P08 Language of Materials: English

01-003-P09 Scope and Content Note: Photocopies of documents belonging to George Douglas, including a Civil War journal describing the battle of Sabine Pass, Texas, a land grant certificate from the governor of Texas, and two photos of Douglas. Includes photocopies of the day book of Nathaniel Lynn Douglas, beginning in 1830, loan and legal papers for the Douglas family, and correspondence between Douglas family members.

01-003-P10 Biographical Note: George Douglas served in the Confederate Army during the Civil War.

01-003-P11 Administrative Information

Immediate Source of Acquisition: unknown

Date of Acquisition: unknown

Accession Number: R 2007.45

Date of Accession: 18 May 2007

Accessioned by: David Sessions, Julia Reid

Processor and Date of Processing: David Sessions, Julia Reid, and Audrey Schaffner, 29 January 2014

Finding Aid Creator and Date: Audrey Schaffner and Mac Ice, 30 January 2014

Finding Aid Update: Mac Ice and Amanda Dietz, 16 January 2019

Scan 004 01-004

Printed finding aid | Source 01, PDF page 4

01-004-P01 Using this collection

Processing Status: Processed

01-004-P02 Conditions Governing Access: Materials are housed in the Abilene Christian University Special Collections and Archives, Brown Library, Abilene Christian University in Abilene, Texas and are non-circulating. Access is available during normal business hours; prior appointments are preferred.

01-004-P03 Conditions Governing Use: Permission to publish, quote or reproduce items from this collection must be secured from the repository and the copyright holder.

01-004-P04 Preferred citation: [identification of item], [file or folder name], George Douglas Papers, 1830-1939. Center for Restoration Studies MS #5. Abilene Christian University Special Collections and Archives, Brown Library. Abilene Christian University, Abilene, TX.

01-004-P05 Copyright notice: Unless transferred in writing to Abilene Christian University, copyright is retained by the authors of these materials, or their descendants, as stipulated by United States Copyright Law (Title 17 US Code). Researchers are responsible for using these materials in conformance with copyright law.

01-004-P06 Arrangement of Materials: Arranged in seven folders numerically. Various collections of letters, legal documents, loan papers, journals, daybooks, and other writings are found in no particular order within each folder.

01-004-P07 Separated Materials: none

01-004-P08 Subjects
 Alexander, Rebecca
 Bass, James
 Bell, Emma
 Bell, George
 Bell, J. M.
 Bell, J. N.
 Bell, Sue
 Douglas, Emily
 Douglas, Gail
 Douglas, George
 Douglas, Henry
 Douglas, Jess
 Douglas, Laura
 Douglas, Lizzie
 Douglas, Mary
 Douglas, N. L.
 Douglas, Sarah

Scan 005 01-005

Printed finding aid | Source 01, PDF page 5

01-005-P01 Douglas, Warren
 Goodloe, L. Columbia
 Goodloe, M. E.
 Goodloe, Rebecca
 Graves, Lizzie
 Headrick, Sarah
 Jettson, L. A.
 Jettson, L. H.
 Jettson, Maybel
 Orr, J. D.
 Stevenson, Miriam

Winneford, N. B.
 Winneford, Rebecca
 Correspondence
 Ephemera
 Manuscripts

01-005-P02 Inventory

01-005-P03 [First Folder] Finding Aid

01-005-P04 Folder 1 - Correspondence, Loan Papers

Copies of numerous correspondence within the Douglas family

Copies of loan papers from 1939

01-005-P05 Folders 2 and 3- Correspondence and Legal Papers

Land deed from 1887

Warranty deed from 1891

To Lizzie Douglas from L. A. Jettson (March 20, 1883, March 3, 1878, Feb. 1, 1874)

To Lizzie Douglas from Maybel Jettson (April 8, 1874)

To Lizzie Douglas from L. Columbia Goodloe (Jan. 21, 1874)

To Lizzie Douglas from Lizzie Graves (two with no date, March 10, 1867, Sep. 16, 1868, Sep. 30, 1867, Aug. 28, 1867, May 10, 1867, Nov. 20, 1868)

To Lizzie Douglas from M. E. Goodloe (Feb. 12, 1865)

To George Douglas from sisters Lizzie and Laura (during Civil War)

To George Douglas from Sue Bell and Lizzie (Aug. 19, 1864)

To George Douglas from Laura Douglas (one with no date, Feb. 1, 1865)

To George Douglas from Lizzie Douglas (three with no date, April 21, 1865, April 14, 1864, Nov. 13, 1864, Feb. 19, 1864, June 28, 1864, April 30, 1864, Sep. 6, 1864, Aug. 5, 1864)

01-005-P06 Various legal papers, including promissory notes, warranty deeds, power of attorney papers, inventory of N. L. Douglas' land (1874), tax documents, and correspondence about the inheritance of Rebecca Alexander

Scan 006 01-006

Printed finding aid | Source 01, PDF page 6

01-006-P01 To N. L. Douglas from Henry Douglas (Jan. 12, 1855)

To Mary Douglas from Henry Douglas (April 8, 1853)

To N. L. Douglas from James Bass (April 18, 1854)

Poem by George Douglas (1867) and various other poems

Two Letters to Lizzie Douglas from Sarah Gail Douglas Headrick (one 1893)

One unidentified letter, and 2 portions of letters (one mentions Lizze and Laura Douglas and one mentions George's death in 1923)

Endorsement from congregation at Sylvana Church for George Douglas in 1883

Sermon notes of L. Douglas in 1883

"The Beauty of Culture" by Sarah Douglas (essay)

"Parting from Friends" by Emma Bell (essay)

To Sue Bell from L. H. Jettson (Feb. 20, 1870)

To George and Lizzie Douglas from Jesse Douglas (Aug. 30, 1869)

To Sarah Douglas from Jesse Douglas (June 15, 1884)

To George Douglas from Jesse Douglas (Nov. 28, 1869)

01-006-P02 Folder 4 – Correspondence

Songs by Emily Douglas

Correspondence from Rebecca Goodloe to her daughters

Correspondence to Mary Douglas from Miriam Stevenson

Various correspondence involving Rebecca Winneford, George Douglas, Lizzie Douglas, N. L. Douglas, Mary Douglas, J. D. Orr, J. M. Bell and Sue Bell, and Laura Douglas

01-006-P03 Folder 5 - Daybook of N.L. Douglas

The Daybook of N. L. Douglas of Murfreesboro TN and Ellis County, Liberty Settlement, Red Oak TX beginning Jan. 4, 1830

Business correspondence of N. L. Douglas

01-006-P04 Folder 6 – Correspondence

To Sue Bell from J. N. Bell (no date)

To Sue Bell from George Douglas (Jan. 28, 1869)

To Lizzie Douglas from George Douglas (March 20, 1864, May 10, 1864, July 10, 1864)

To George Douglas from Sue Bell (one with no date, Feb. 10, 1863, May 7, 1863)

To George Douglas from J. M. Bell (April 2, 1864)

To George Douglas from Lizzie and Laura (Jan. 11, 1864)

To George Bell from Rebecca Winneford (July 23, 1864, Feb. 21, 1864, May 12, 1863, Sep. 4, 1864, Dec. 11, 1864, March 5, 1864)

To George Douglas from N. B. Winneford (1863)

To George Douglas from Lizzie Douglas (two from 1863 - month unknown, April 15, 1863, Jan. 22, 1863, Feb. 10, 1863, May 7, 1863, April 2, 1863)

To George and Warren from Lizzie (Jan. 28, 1863)

01-006-P05 Folder 7 - Poems, Etc.

Numerous poems by George Douglas from 1860's and 1870's

Essay: "What are social parties?" by George Douglas

Copy of George's personal notebook, including financial records and personal recordings

Editorial note. The repository describes folders 4–7 here; their manuscript scans are not included among the supplied PDFs.

Source 02

ACU CRS MS5 - 02 - L. Douglas Sermon Notes, 16 Feb 1883.pdf

4 PDF scan pages including the repository cover.

SHA-256: d0f97a4967414638c7ebf74064633a5571f39f6cb6d753971b79bed17d75daed

Scan 001 02-001

Repository cover | Source 02, PDF page 1

02-001-P01 Abilene Christian University
Digital Commons @ ACU

02-001-P02 George Douglas Papers
Manuscripts, Personal Papers and Archival Records

02-001-P03 2-16-1883

02-001-P04 L. Douglas sermon notes

02-001-P05 L. Douglas

02-001-P06 Follow this and additional works at: https://digitalcommons.acu.edu/george_douglas
Part of the Christianity Commons, Genealogy Commons, Military History Commons, Social History Commons, and the United States History Commons

Scan 002 02-002

Identifying slip | Source 02, PDF page 2

02-002-P01 Sermon notes
Sylvana Church
(Brushy Creek)
Feb 16, 1883
L(?) Douglas

Editorial note. The parenthetical question mark follows the initial in the identifying slip.

Scan 003 02-003

Manuscript | Source 02, PDF page 3

02-003-P01 Of all the thoughts enclosed in the language of Inspiration *[[lost: left edge]]* its laws its precepts its promises what is there that conveys more, to our minds and hearts than is expressed in this short sentence? Jesus wept. Let us look a moment at the character of Jesus: who, and what is he? If we accept the truths of the Bible, he is the son of God, The King of the Jews, The bright and morning star! A ruler of the Jews came to Jesus and said, "we know thou art a teacher come from God for no man can do the miracles that thou doest, except God be with him." Look then at the power of this man: by his word water is turned into wine. The blind receive their sight, the lame walk. By His word the tempest is stilled, and He walks the waves of the wild Galilee. By His word the dead are called back to life again. Truly He was the son of God.

02-003-P02 But it is not from the Bible alone that we have testimony in regard to the greatness of this man. Renan in his Life of Christ says "All ages will proclaim that among the sons of men there were none born greater than Jesus." His goodness, *[[greatness?]]*, his omnipotent power, we cannot doubt. We stand in awe as we contemplate them, and our hearts acknowledge him as King of Kings and Lord of Lords. But while we contemplate all of this glorious majesty our eye falls upon this simple sentence Jesus wept. What do we learn by this? by these two short words. We learn that He had a heart that could be touched by the sorrows and Suffering of our frail humanity: that Sympath~~[[lost: torn edge]]~~

Editorial note. First word and left edge of the second line are damaged. The terminal word is torn; it has not been completed from context. Text continues on scan page 4.

Scan 004 02-004

Manuscript | Source 02, PDF page 4

02-004-P01 the power to "make e'en the wretched blessed" had its abode in His breast and that He could be touched by a feeling of our infirmities. How our hearts thrill with emotions of Love and thankfulness when we think of this blessed truth, that He was in sympathy with the sorrows of frail humanity.

02-004-P02 More than eighteen hundred years have been measured by the revolving Earth since Jesus walked the shores and waves of Galilee, but the influence of His words and life, are still felt. And down through the vista of the coming Ages they will be felt till time shall be no more. And with all the records of His wonderful life this simple truth will descend with the others, Jesus wept.

02-004-P03 L. Douglas.
Sylvana Feb 16th 1883

02-004-P04 Forever reign victorious King
Wide through the earth thy name be known;
And call our longing Souls to sing,
Sublimest anthems near thy throne.

Editorial note. Continues the damaged sentence at the end of scan page 3. The final four lines are verse.

Source 03

ACU CRS MS5 - 03 - Sylvana Church Endorsement for George Douglas, Sept 1888.pdf

5 PDF scan pages including the repository cover.

SHA-256: ffd6cdfaac980365018773c286940767b5bce0c3c1ab285c3c7ad1b434263d57

Scan 001 03-001

Repository cover | Source 03, PDF page 1

03-001-P01 Abilene Christian University
Digital Commons @ ACU

03-001-P02 George Douglas Papers
Manuscripts, Personal Papers and Archival Records

03-001-P03 9-1888

03-001-P04 Endorsement from congregation at Sylvana Church for George Douglas

03-001-P05 Sylvana Church

03-001-P06 Follow this and additional works at: https://digitalcommons.acu.edu/george_douglas
Part of the Christianity Commons, Genealogy Commons, Military History Commons, Social History Commons, and the United States History Commons

Scan 002 03-002

Identifying slip | Source 03, PDF page 2

03-002-P01 Endorsement of the
Congregation
(for) Sylvana Church.
George Douglas
Sept 1888 -
Elders H. Douglas
H. G. Orr

Scan 003 03-003

Manuscript | Source 03, PDF page 3

03-003-P01 This certifies that Bro. George Douglas, who is a member of the Church of Christ worshipping at Sylvana Ellis County Texas, has for some length of time been laboring in word and doctrine, and wishing him to continue in the work, we take pleasure in stating that he goes with our full permission & hearty approval. May he realize with the Apostle Paul. "Woe is me if I preach not the Gospel of Christ" - Ever remembering the Solemn Charge to Timothy to preach the Word &c -

Editorial note. Several letters fade at the right edge. Hyphenation in Gospel at the line break is joined. The final abbreviation is read as &c.

Scan 004 03-004

Document endorsement | Source 03, PDF page 4

03-004-P01 Endorsement
of the
Sylvana Congregation

Editorial note. The docket is faint; the title can be read across the folded sheet.

Scan 005 03-005

Manuscript | Source 03, PDF page 5

03-005-P01 Given by Order of the Church
On the 2nd Lords day in
Sept 1888

03-005-P02 Elders
H. Douglas
H G Orr

Editorial note. A brace groups the two names under Elders. The manuscript year reads 1888; the printed finding aid lists 1883.